

JC4000 (2025-26): Graduation Thesis

The Interim Report Guidelines

Once your project has begun, the first deliverable is the Interim Report, also known as the Project Plan. This plan, developed in consultation with your supervisor, should outline your intended approach and timeline for completing the assigned topic. A well-crafted Project Plan typically includes several achievable goals, as well as optional "nice-to-have" features that could be pursued if time permits.

Your Project Plan will serve as a valuable benchmark throughout the project, helping you assess your progress and stay on track.

Structure

Your plan should be concise, limited to a maximum of four typed A4 pages (11-point for fonts like Calibri, Arial, or Helvetica or 12-point for fonts like Times New Roman or Garamond) and should include the following key elements:

- **Title:** Clearly state the project's title (descriptive title, not just a topic name) to set the context.
- **Introduction:** Provide background information on the project and explain why it is significant and worth pursuing.
- **Goals:** Specify the primary objectives of the project, distinguishing between core goals and optional extras that could be added if time allows.
- **Methodology:** This section should describe how you will conduct your project
- **Resources List:** Detail the hardware, software, and any other resources needed to complete the project.
- **Risk Assessment:** Identify potential risks or situations that could make the project unfeasible and outline the measures or contingency plans for project recovery.
- **Timetable:** Present a timeline that outlines major milestones and deadlines to help manage the project schedule effectively.
- Provide appropriate references throughout your proposal

Ideally, a plan will include a basic project, which should be straightforward to implement, and which should be completed reasonably early. It should also include more ambitious extensions, or possible developments to be tackled depending on the results of your

initial work. A well-planned project should not be one which only comes together at the end of the period.

Recommended Template and Example Project Plan Documents

An example template of the interim report, and a ZIP/RAR file of the corresponding LaTeX source is available within the “Interim Report” folder under “Course Assessment” on MyAberdeen. You will also find some example project plans for your reference.

In the same folder, you will find several example project plan documents to help guide the preparation of your own plan.

Marking Criteria

The criteria listed below are general guidelines. The project report will be evaluated holistically, and the relevance of each criterion may vary depending on the project’s topic and context.

- Clear explanation of the project's background and its importance.
- Well-defined and achievable goals, distinguishing between core and optional elements.
- Appropriate methodology
- Identification of potential risks and contingency plans for recovery.
- Appropriate list of necessary hardware, software, and other resources.
- Realistic and organized timeline with clear milestones and deadlines.
- Professional presentation, clear structure, and proper referencing.

Submission

Once you have agreed your plan with your supervisor, please then: submit it on MyAberdeen via the given submission link, as a PDF attachment before the deadline.